



PAPUA NEW GUINEA

POLESTAR INSIGHTS

REPORTING PERIOD: 9 JULY 2026 - 15 JULY 2026

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BOTTOM LINE UP FRONT

The operating picture for Papua New Guinea this period looks to be deteriorating: the bulk of reporting concerns violent crime concentrated around Enga and National Capital District. For business users, the principal business risk is direct exposure to violence and disruption at affected sites.

TOP 3 DEVELOPMENTS

Three shot dead, five injured, two on the run in Papua New Guinea prison escape - reports Homicide / violent crime · Reported 13 Jul 2026 · RNZ Heightened personal-security risk locally; review after-hours exposure and movement protocols.	HIGH
Enga still tops PNG’s gun violence hotspot, tracking data shows Homicide / violent crime · Enga · Reported 09 Jul 2026 · Post-Courier (PNG) Heightened personal-security risk locally; review after-hours exposure and movement protocols.	HIGH
Consistency in Selection Ahead of Blackhawks Clash Other security · Reported 15 Jul 2026 · Post-Courier Security-relevant development; monitor for operational follow-on in the affected area.	HIGH

INCIDENT DETAILS

PROTEST & CIVIL UNREST

Protest activity and the crowd-control response to it were reported, including civil unrest. It concentrated in National Capital District and Western. The most serious reported was ‘Leadership means stepping aside’: Pascoe Events founder declines WOW Awards Nomination to make space for rising leaders, assessed as Low severity. Gatherings and the response to them can close roads and disrupt access at short notice.

‘Leadership means stepping aside’: Pascoe Events founder declines WOW Awards Nomination to make space for rising leaders Civil unrest / protest · Location not specified · Reported 15 Jul 2026 · Post-Courier (PNG)	LOW
U.S., Papua New Guinea launch Tamiok Strike 26 [Image 4 of 8] - DVIDS Civil unrest / protest · Location not specified · Reported 15 Jul 2026 · Google News — Papua New Guinea (Civil Unrest)	LOW
US, Papua New Guinea launch Tamiok Strike 26 - army.mil Civil unrest / protest · Location not specified · Reported 15 Jul 2026 · Google News — Papua New Guinea (Crime & Security)	LOW
Peace Mediation Brings Southern Highlands and Nomad Communities Together in Kiunga Civil unrest / protest · Western · Reported 14 Jul 2026 · Post-Courier	LOW
News - U.S., Papua New Guinea launch Tamiok Strike 26 - DVIDS Civil unrest / protest · Location not specified · Reported 14 Jul 2026 · Google News — Papua New Guinea (Civil Unrest)	LOW

Public outcry over Hohola incident as viral video shows onlookers looting instead of helping

Civil unrest / protest · National Capital District · Reported 13 Jul 2026 · Post-Courier (PNG)

LOW

U.S. Embassy Port Moresby announces Exercise Tamiok Strike 2026

Civil unrest / protest · National Capital District · Reported 09 Jul 2026 · Google News — Papua New Guinea (Civil Unrest)

LOW

CRIME, THEFT & ROBBERY

Crime, theft and violent incidents were reported, including violent crime. It concentrated in Morobe and Enga. The most serious reported was Twenty-seven locked-up from second ‘Sambio massacre’ arrest (Morobe), assessed as Extreme severity. Incidents of this kind threaten staff, premises and the movement of cash and assets.

Twenty-seven locked-up from second ‘Sambio massacre’ arrest

Homicide / violent crime · Morobe · Reported 15 Jul 2026 · Post-Courier (PNG)

EXTREME

TWENTY-SEVEN ARRESTED AND CHARGED OVER SAMBIO MASSACRE

Homicide / violent crime · Location not specified · Reported 15 Jul 2026 · RPNGC (PNG Police, confirmation)

EXTREME

DRIVER MURDER INVESTIGATION CONTINUES FOLLOWING FATAL BENA ROAD ACCIDENT

Homicide / violent crime · Location not specified · Reported 15 Jul 2026 · EMTV (PNG)

HIGH

Three Killed in Baisu Prison Escape

Homicide / violent crime · Location not specified · Reported 12 Jul 2026 · Post-Courier

HIGH

Kokopau Community Rallies Against Violence: Robust Awareness Initiative Transforms Local Wards

Homicide / violent crime · Location not specified · Reported 15 Jul 2026 · Post-Courier (PNG)

LOW

Dilapidated infrastructure blamed for fatal PNG prison escape attempt

Homicide / violent crime · Location not specified · Reported 13 Jul 2026 · RNZ Pacific

LOW

Enga murders drop dramatically

Homicide / violent crime · Enga · Reported 09 Jul 2026 · NBC PNG

LOW

NATURAL HAZARDS

Natural-hazard and environmental disruption was reported, including natural hazard. It concentrated in East New Britain. The most serious reported was ENB opens first permanent FODE centre since volcanic eruption (East New Britain), assessed as Low severity. Hazards of this kind can interrupt transport, utilities and site access.

ENB opens first permanent FODE centre since volcanic eruption

Natural hazard · East New Britain · Reported 14 Jul 2026 · Post-Courier

LOW

Magnitude 6.4 quake strikes off Papua New Guinea

Natural hazard · Location not specified · Reported 13 Jul 2026 · Google News — Papua New Guinea (Civil Unrest)

LOW

Mulitaka resettlement authority demands release of reports

LOW

Natural hazard · Location not specified · Reported 13 Jul 2026 · Post-Courier

GOVERNANCE & REGULATORY

Policing, regulatory and political-stability activity was reported, including corrections and community policing. It concentrated in Bougainville. The most serious reported was Alcohol-Fueled Crime Hinders Progress: North Bougainville Women Demand Village-Level Community Policing, assessed as Low severity. Regulatory, policing and political-stability friction can affect compliance, permits and freedom of movement.

Alcohol-Fueled Crime Hinders Progress: North Bougainville Women Demand Village-Level Community Policing

LOW

Community policing · Bougainville · Reported 15 Jul 2026 · Post-Courier (PNG)

3 dead while two still on the run in Baisu prison escape

LOW

Corrections / detention · Location not specified · Reported 13 Jul 2026 · NBC PNG

Three recaptured after 38 remandees escape Kerevat prison

LOW

Corrections / detention · Location not specified · Reported 09 Jul 2026 · Post-Courier (PNG)

OTHER OPERATIONAL DISRUPTION

Operational disruption to transport, utilities or connectivity was reported, including other security, telecoms and aviation. It concentrated in Enga and East Sepik. The most serious reported was Angoram police station closed indefinitely after violent tribal attack (East Sepik), assessed as High severity. Disruption of this kind can interrupt operations, logistics and connectivity.

Angoram police station closed indefinitely after violent tribal attack

HIGH

Other security · East Sepik · Reported 09 Jul 2026 · NBC PNG

Digicel Foundation support schools

LOW

Telecoms / connectivity · Location not specified · Reported 15 Jul 2026 · Post-Courier (PNG)

Police rescue elderly woman tortured over sorcery accusations in Enga

LOW

Other security · Enga · Reported 10 Jul 2026 · NBC PNG

Drone operators warned over illegal flights

LOW

Aviation / airport · Location not specified · Reported 09 Jul 2026 · NBC PNG

CURRENT SITUATION

The security picture in Papua New Guinea this period was dominated by violent crime, protest and civil unrest and other security-relevant incidents. Reporting clustered around Enga, National Capital District and Bougainville. The most serious entry reached Extreme severity.

The picture is operational rather than a single dramatic event: the priority for business users is movement security, premises protection and continuity at exposed sites while this picture holds.

OPERATIONAL IMPACT

Protest & civil unrest — Gatherings and crowd-control responses can close roads and disrupt access at short notice; build in transit buffers

and keep routes flexible.

Crime, theft & robbery – Direct threat to staff, premises and the movement of cash or assets; harden security, vary routines and brief travellers.

Natural hazards – Weather and geological hazards can interrupt transport, utilities and site access; check conditions before movement and confirm site readiness.

Governance & regulatory – Regulatory, policing and political-stability friction can affect compliance, permits and freedom of movement; monitor official guidance.

Other operational disruption – Transport, utilities and connectivity disruption can interrupt operations and logistics; plan for contingencies and alternate routing.

RECOMMENDED ACTIONS

MOVEMENT SECURITY

Vary routes and timings, avoid predictable patterns, and confirm route status before travel.

Route around gatherings, rallies and choke points, and build in extra transit time.

Treat areas with confirmed violence as no-go for non-essential travel; use secure transport for any essential movement.

SITE SECURITY

Maintain premises protection: access control, guarding and after-hours security at exposed sites.

STAFF AWARENESS

Brief staff and travellers on current risks, local reporting lines and areas to avoid.

Remind staff to keep a low profile with cash, devices and valuables in public.

JOURNEY PLANNING

Confirm road, air and port status before travel and hold viable alternates.

Check weather and hazard conditions before movement and allow for delays.

ESCALATION TRIGGERS

Activate contingency and movement-restriction plans if higher-severity or casualty-bearing incidents reach or near operating sites.

LOCAL MONITORING

Track local reporting and official advisories for the locations on the watchlist, and reassess as fresh reporting comes through.

OUTLOOK: NEXT SEVEN DAYS

The coming week most likely follows the current pattern, led by violent crime, with protest and civil unrest also likely to recur. Key locations to watch: Enga and National Capital District.

Escalation triggers: a spread of high-severity or casualty-bearing incidents beyond the locations above, and flashpoints around paydays, court rulings, election cycles and tribal-payback events.

Concern would ease with a sustained quiet stretch across Enga and National Capital District, no further high-severity or casualty-bearing incidents, and no spread to new districts. Were the picture to deteriorate, expect direct disruption to movement and site access at the affected locations, with knock-on delays to staff travel and logistics.

ESCALATION INDICATORS

Larger or coordinated protest mobilisation, or labour action spreading to key sites and corridors

Further casualty-bearing or higher-severity violence at or near operating sites

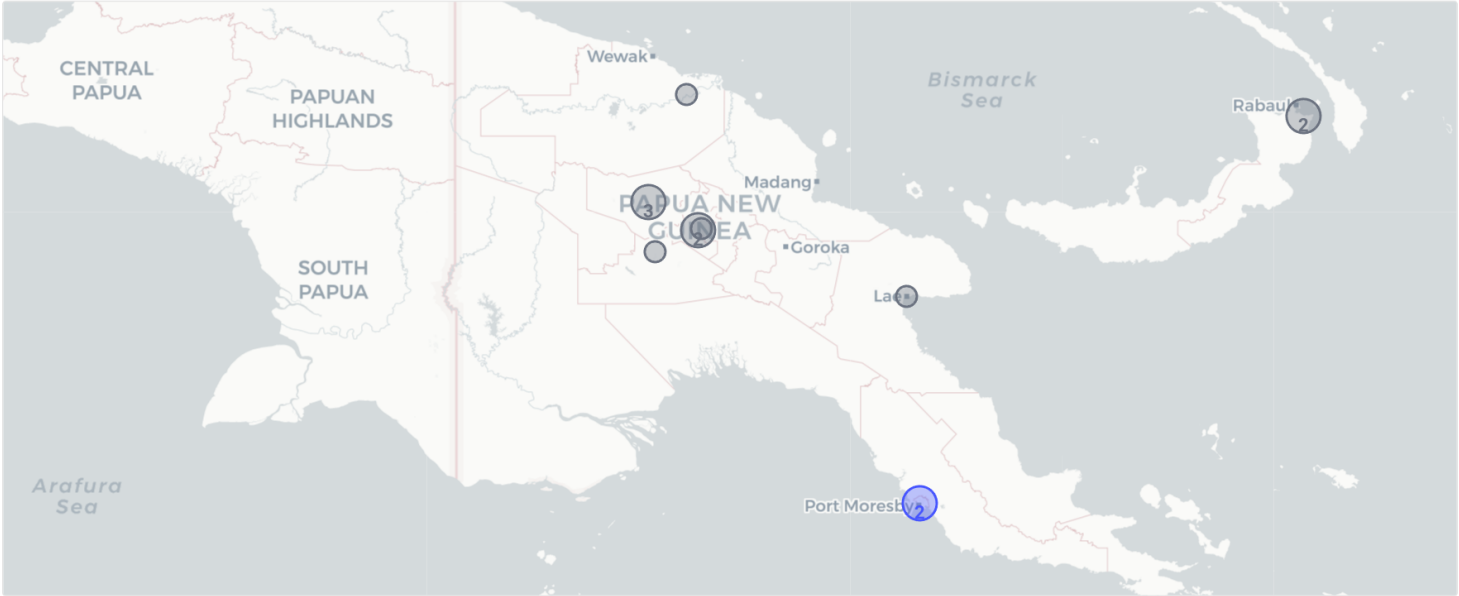
Spread of incidents beyond Enga and Port Moresby / National Capital District into new districts

POLESTAR VIEW

Polestar assesses that operating risk in Papua New Guinea is deteriorating, driven by crime and violent incidents, protest and civil unrest and transport and utility disruption. The main business exposure is staff safety, secure movement of cash and assets and staff movement. The most exposed areas are Enga, Port Moresby / National Capital District and Bougainville. The most likely disruption over the next seven days is continued exposure to violent and opportunistic crime. The assessment would worsen if larger-scale incidents, casualty-bearing violence or sustained disruption emerge around paydays, court rulings, election cycles and tribal-payback events. For now, operators should tighten movement planning and site protection at the exposed locations and keep contingency arrangements under active review.

Operational Map

Reported operational issues this period



● Direct impact ● Indirect impact ● Monitor only

● Lae Impact level: Monitor only What happened this period: Twenty-seven locked Business relevance: No reported commercial impact	● Port Moresby Impact level: Indirect impact What happened this period: U.S. Embassy Port Moresby announces Exercise Tamiok Strike 2026 Business relevance: Possible movement disruption near protest area	● Western Highlands Impact level: Monitor only What happened this period: Three Killed in Baisu Prison Escape Business relevance: Local security awareness only
● Enga Impact level: Monitor only What happened this period: Enga still tops PNG's gun violence hotspot, tracking data shows Business relevance: No reported commercial impact	● Angoram Impact level: Monitor only What happened this period: Angoram police station closed indefinitely after violent tribal attack Business relevance: Local security awareness only	● Bougainville Impact level: Monitor only What happened this period: Alcohol-Fueled Crime Hinders Progress: North Bougainville Women Demand Village Business relevance: No reported commercial impact
● Southern Highlands Impact level: Monitor only What happened this period: Peace Mediation Brings Southern Highlands and Nomad Communities Together in Kiunga Business relevance: No reported commercial impact	● East New Britain Impact level: Monitor only What happened this period: ENB opens first permanent FODE centre since volcanic eruption Business relevance: No reported commercial impact	● Baisu Impact level: Monitor only What happened this period: 3 dead while two still on the run in Baisu prison escape Business relevance: No reported commercial impact

Points show reported events at the town or province named in the reporting; where several share a location one marker carries the count. A marker is a town or province-level fix, not an exact point. 13 of 27 records name no specific place and are included in the totals and tables but not plotted.

Map Read

This map shows reported operationally relevant issues for the current reporting period. Not every security or crime incident creates commercial impact. Direct impact is used only where reporting shows a current or confirmed effect on operations, movement, access, site security, utilities, production, logistics, workforce

safety or business continuity. Indirect impact marks issues relevant to the operating environment with no confirmed effect on a client site, route, workforce, movement, production, access, utilities or logistics. Background incidents, preparedness meetings, isolated crime, political or legal developments, corruption investigations and general policing are Monitor only unless a clear operational effect is reported.

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